

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 8: Safety Department **POLICY: 8.015**

SUBJECT: Communication System Testing

POINT PERSON: Director of Safety

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD
Interim Superintendent



DATE: NOVEMBER 15, 2024

SELECT ONE:

☐ New policy

☒ Minor/technical revision of existing policy

☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy

☐ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. Oregon State Hospital will maintain a safe environment for patients, staff, and others by conducting regular testing of communication systems, including but not limited to the duress alarm system and Everbridge system in accordance with applicable regulations, this policy and procedures, and department protocols.
- B. This policy applies to all staff at OSH.

II. POLICY

- A. Communication systems must be regularly tested by Security, Safety, and designated unit staff.
- B. PMTs must be tested in accordance with OSH Policy and Procedure 8.035, "Duress Alarm System".
 - a. PMT testing locations are located at Junction City Sallyport 1 and Salem Sallyports 2, 5, and 7.
 - b. Staff may contact Junction City Access Control at (541) 465-3000 or Salem Access Control at (503) 947-9984 for assistance with testing.
- C. If any device within the duress alarm system fails to meet its self-monitoring requirements, an error message must be sent to the monitoring stations in Access Control.
- D. Upon receipt of a system reporting error, Access Control staff must report the error to the Duress Coordinator or designee. The Duress Coordinator must verify and ensure appropriate corrective actions are

taken, including submitting work requests for repair.

- E. Radios assigned to an individual staff or unit must be tested prior to each shift and use involving patient movement as outlined in OSH Policy & Procedure, 6.006, *On-grounds and Off-grounds Movement*.
 - a. For radio issues or broken equipment, contact Oregon State Hospital Security Office at (503) 945-2800 (Salem) or (541) 465-3000 (Junction City).
- F. The public-address system must be tested campus-wide on a monthly cycle. Confirmation of adequate volume and clarity in each area must be recorded on the checklist.
- G. Blue emergency phones on the OSH Junction City property must be tested monthly by Security staff and results documented. System failures must be immediately reported to Facilities for repair or servicing.
- H. Safety staff will test satellite phones on a weekly basis and before staff assigned to patient outings to locations with poor or no cellular service.
- I. The Security Director, Safety Director, Duress Coordinator, the Environmental Safety & Emergency Preparedness Manager or designee is responsible for testing completion and must submit any work requests necessary to repair communication system issues discovered during testing.
- J. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- K. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. "Duress alarm system" means a non-medical emergency alarm system consisting of personal mobile transmitters, fixed position transmitters, annunciator panels, and a camera monitoring system.
- B. "Everbridge system" refers to a mass communication system used to notify individuals or groups in the event of an emergency.
- C. "Fixed position transmitter (FPT)" means a stationary "push button" or equivalent device which transmits an emergency signal and location to

hospital annunciators and the Security Department.

- D. "Personal mobile transmitter (PMT)" means a device that, upon activation for a non-medical emergency, transmits a signal to hospital annunciators and the Security Department.
- E. "Public address system" means an overhead paging system controlled by the Access Control operator.
- F. "Two-way radio" means a multi-channel handheld device that transmits verbal communications using radio frequencies.
- G. "Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and state employees assigned to work at Oregon State Hospital (OSH)

IV. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

6.006 On-grounds and Off-grounds Movement

8.033 Workplace Violence Response

8.035 Duress alarm system

V. REFERENCES

42 CFR § 482.15.